



Social Psychology (SOCPSY)

Module 4: Individuals and Groups

Facilitation, Loafing and Groupthink

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

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Social Facilitation and Social Loafing

Social facilitation is the effect of an audience on performance. Presence of others can improve performance on simple or well-learned tasks and can hurt performance on complex new tasks. Social loafing is reduced individual effort in a group task when people assume others will cover them.

An experienced presenter may perform better with an audience. In a six-person university project, some members may contribute little if contribution is not visible.

Groupthink

Groupthink occurs when the desire for harmony overrides careful decision-making. Members suppress doubts. Warning signs include an illusion of invulnerability, pressure on dissenters, and silence treated as agreement.

Polarisation and Deindividuation

Group polarisation means discussion makes initial opinions more extreme. Deindividuation is reduced personal accountability in crowds or anonymity, which can increase impulsive behaviour, including online.

Reflect: *In your last group assignment, did you see loafing, facilitation, or pressure to agree?*

Closing

These group processes are common in student teams. The next lesson focuses on practical habits for better group work.